ACCESSROUTE HK · PRODUCT MANUAL

# Plan an accessible first- and last-mile journey

Current demo edition · English

Prepared 14 October 2026 · Updated against the project in this workspace

> **What this guide is:** a visual guide to the current AccessRoute HK research demo, including a clear change log against the supplied 24-page Product Manual.




The current mobile map-first interface: places and map above an expandable journey-planning sheet.

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Research demonstration only — not certified real-world accessibility navigation.

01 · WHAT'S CHANGED

# Changes since the supplied manual

This comparison uses the supplied *AccessRoute HK Product Manual* PDF and the current repository's product-manual parity audit. “Changed” means the current project documents or implements a difference; it does not imply every earlier feature was new or has been independently field-tested.

| Area | Current change or clarification | Status |
|---|---|---|
| Starting screen | The regular app entry now opens a map-first journey flow: choose places, set mobility needs, compare a route, then navigate or request help. The earlier full planning workspace remains available at `/?legacy=1`. | Changed |
| Mobility setup | The current map-card flow exposes five profiles (walking, wheelchair, elderly, stroller and heavy luggage) and additional caregiver controls for lifts, stairs/escalators, slope, pace and route goal. | Expanded |
| Weather | Weather can use Hong Kong Observatory open data. The service reports whether a result is live or a previously cached stale snapshot; territory-wide weather is not precise local forecasting. | Updated |
| Accessibility evidence | Route information is more explicit that many source accessibility attributes remain unknown. A “verified routes only” option can exclude unknown segments; a route result is not an accessibility certification. | Clarified |
| Accessibility of the interface | The project now includes skip navigation, visible keyboard focus, larger touch targets, reduced-motion handling and high-contrast support in relevant views. | Improved |
| AI assistance | Text preferences, photo obstacle reports, photo location help and generated guidance are presented as separate workflows. Real provider calls and real-world recognition quality are not certified by UI or mock tests. | Clarified |
| End-to-end claims | The exact 13-step journey in the old manual and its accuracy targets have not been independently reproduced. Live indoor positioning, live MTR accessibility and full phone/operator integration remain out of scope or partial. | Important limitation |

> **Read before travelling:** this product remains a research demo. Route geometry, entrances, slopes, lifts and public access must be checked in person.

The app still includes 12 selectable scenes, map views, route calculation and demo elevator events. These are not listed as new changes because the supplied manual already describes overlapping capabilities.

02 · OLD-MANUAL FEATURE CHECK · 1/2

# Core journey and map functions

**Many core planning and map functions are available, but the newest app does not fully match the old manual.** This table checks the manual's named workflows against the current project audit. “Partial” means a demo path exists but a dependency, exact workflow, live service or real-device result is not verified.

| Old-manual function | Current status | What works / what does not |
|---|---|---|
| Choose and swap places in the 12-scene catalogue | Available | Places are independently selectable; local routes recalculate when changed or swapped. |
| Caregiver defaults, profiles and passage limits | Partial | Profiles and several lift/stair/slope/route settings feed local routing. Settings are browser-local, not shared across accounts; the old 1 m minimum-width example is not verified as a current control. |
| Continuous walk → rail → walk journey and exactly 13 steps | Partial | Walking legs can be composed with a saved MTR station sequence and transfer instructions. Timetables/accessibility data are not live, and the old exact 13-step route is not reproduced (current default can produce 14 or more steps). |
| Maps, current/next step, step completion and accessible routing | Partial | Floor/overview maps and user-advanced steps work. There is no live indoor position, and graph accessibility facts remain incomplete or unknown. |
| Three Kowloon Tong branches: outdoor, mall A and mall B | Unavailable | These manual-specific branches are deferred because verified branch endpoints/topology are unavailable. Do not rely on their old distances. |
| Report a lift problem and reroute | Partial | Demo facility closure/restoration can reroute the remaining graph path. The full live photo-to-AI matching flow and real operator alert are not verified. |
| Wait for a lift, restore it and resume with an operator | Partial | Local session/operator controls and update streaming exist. Production authentication and multi-process synchronization are not in place. |
| Find a location from a landmark photo | Mock-only verification | A mocked candidate can be previewed, confirmed and applied. Real photo recognition and GPS matching are not verified. |

03 · OLD-MANUAL FEATURE CHECK · 2/2

# AI, weather and accessibility functions

The statuses below distinguish a local interface or code path from an available, measured external service.

| Old-manual function | Current status | What works / what does not |
|---|---|---|
| HKO weather and sheltered-route changes | Partial | The backend reads HKO feeds and identifies live/stale data; location can be territory-wide or approximate. Device accuracy and sustained live operation are not certified. |
| Nearby Street View panorama | Unavailable | No Street View provider or panorama endpoint is implemented. |
| Natural-language preferences | Partial | A review/apply workflow exists. Live language parsing requires a configured model provider and has not been benchmarked. |
| Cantonese voice input | Partial | Press-to-speak is available in browsers that expose Web Speech API; actual microphone/service behavior has not been device-tested. |
| Automatic Cantonese narration | Locally implemented | Browser speech synthesis can read active steps if the device has a Hong Kong Cantonese voice; physical-device output is unverified. |
| GenAI accuracy, workflow success and cost targets | Not measured | The old manual's percentages and token-cost figures are targets/examples, not current measured results. |
| WCAG conformance and assistive-technology use | Not certified | Keyboard, focus, contrast and responsive checks have improved; full WCAG conformance and VoiceOver/TalkBack use have not been verified. |

**Bottom line:** use the current app for a supervised demo of supported local workflows. Do not treat unavailable or partial items as live services, verified routes or safety guarantees.

04 · GET STARTED

# Start the demo

## First-time setup

1. Install Node.js 22 LTS or newer on Windows or macOS.
2. Extract the project folder. Open a terminal in that folder.
3. Install dependencies and start the local demo:

```
npm ci
npm run dev
```

4. Open http://127.0.0.1:5173/map-demo/index.html in a modern browser. Keep the terminal running while using the demo.

On later visits, run `npm run dev` and reopen the address. Stop the demo with `Ctrl+C` in the terminal.

## Optional: enable Qwen-powered assistance

Route planning works without an AI key. To enable the Qwen workflows, copy `.env.example` to `.env`, set your private `DASHSCOPE_API_KEY` in that local file, then restart the demo. Never paste the key into the browser or share it in screenshots.

```
DASHSCOPE_API_KEY=your_private_key
```

> **Production build:** for the locally served production build, run `npm run build`, then `npm start` and open `http://127.0.0.1:8787/map-demo/index.html`.

05 · PLAN A ROUTE

# Choose places and travel needs

1. Select the place pill at the top of the map, choose a departure and destination, then apply the selection.
2. Expand the bottom sheet and choose a profile: walking, wheelchair, elderly, stroller or heavy luggage. Adjust the available route preferences as needed.
3. Select **Search route** at the bottom of the screen.
4. Compare the sheltered and shorter route options, review their limitations, then select **Start navigation**.




Map and journey sheet in the current mobile interface; screen labels are in Hong Kong Traditional Chinese.

## Compare map views

Use the overview map for the surrounding route and the floor-navigation view for indoor floor geometry. Use the floor controls and map zoom controls to inspect a level. Follow the displayed route segments, but treat every path as a demo unless verified independently.




Route choices appear in the same map-and-bottom-sheet layout. Distances and accessibility attributes are demonstration data and may be unverified.

> **Unknown is not accessible:** source data can describe geometry without confirming door widths, gradients, operating hours, permission to pass or lift service. Even “verified routes only” does not certify the remaining route.

06 · NAVIGATE AND REQUEST HELP

# Follow steps and handle a demo closure

1. Start the navigation demonstration from the route preview.
2. Read the current instruction and inspect the corresponding map segment or floor.
3. Advance a step using the on-screen control after you have checked your surroundings. Progress is user-operated; it is not live indoor positioning.
4. In the elevator-event demo, simulate a lift outage to see the remaining route recalculate. Restore the lift or reset the journey when finished.




Step-by-step demo guidance. Progress is user-operated; it is not live indoor positioning.

# Optional AI help

Use the **?** help control for facility or location assistance. Travel preferences are entered in the planning sheet. Depending on the workflow, Qwen requires a configured backend; review any proposed match or route change before applying it:

- **Travel preferences:** describe needs in text and review the suggested preference changes before applying them.
- **Photo obstacle report:** submit a photo and review the proposed facility/candidate before applying an event or reroute.
- **Photo location help:** review matched place candidates and confirm the right one before changing the route start.
- **Voice guidance:** request the next instruction; browser speech output depends on the device's installed language voice.

07 · ACCESSIBILITY, WEATHER AND BOUNDARIES

# Use the interface accessibly

- Use the skip link and keyboard focus outline to move through the main screen without starting at every control.
- Use browser/device text scaling, high contrast and reduced motion where available. Some demo screens also expose larger text or touch-target presentation.
- For voice output, enable a Cantonese (Hong Kong) voice in the operating system if available. Actual microphone recognition and speech output are device/browser dependent.

## Weather information

When the backend is running and weather data is available, the app can show Hong Kong Observatory observations, forecast and warning data. Check its live/stale indicator and update time. Territory-wide readings may not reflect conditions at your current street or building.

## Known limits

### Location and navigation

- No continuous real-time indoor positioning.
- Step progress is advanced by the user.
- Map coverage is limited to the demo scenes.

### Accessibility and transit

- Many access attributes remain unknown and need field verification.
- Lift status is simulated, not a live feed.
- Saved MTR connections are not live schedules, fares or accessibility data.

### AI and photos

- AI needs a configured backend key and network access.
- Recognition and provider behavior have not been certified in real-world use.
- Always review and confirm proposed candidates.

### Accounts and service

- Settings may be stored only in the local browser.
- Session/operator functions are for the local demo, not a production service.
- Accessibility checks do not equal WCAG certification.

**Safety note:** AccessRoute HK is a research demonstration, not certified real-world accessibility navigation. Confirm route conditions, public access, station facilities, lift availability and safety information before travelling. If in doubt, use a verified alternative or ask the venue/operator for assistance.

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Reference: `docs/acceptance.md` (Product Manual parity audit, 13 October 2026); current project state snapshot: 14 October 2026. This guide is an updated companion to the supplied English PDF, not a claim that every old-manual workflow is complete.